

Fly where the air is thin.

Opportunity is demand that already exists, on planes that are already full, on a route nobody owns.

D

Is the market real?

Q4 passengers, 2015-19

G

Is it getting bigger?

versus 2010-14

S

Are the planes full?

passengers ÷ departures

R

Can we get in?

1 – HHI of carrier shares

WHERE MERIDIAN STANDS

One aircraft. No slots. No feed.

The weaknesses are the reason we score capturability instead of size.

STRENGTHS

Capital in hand
No legacy network to defend
Small, reversible commitment

OPPORTUNITIES

Failed carriers leave proven demand
Second cities are unslotted
Monopoly routes price high

WEAKNESSES

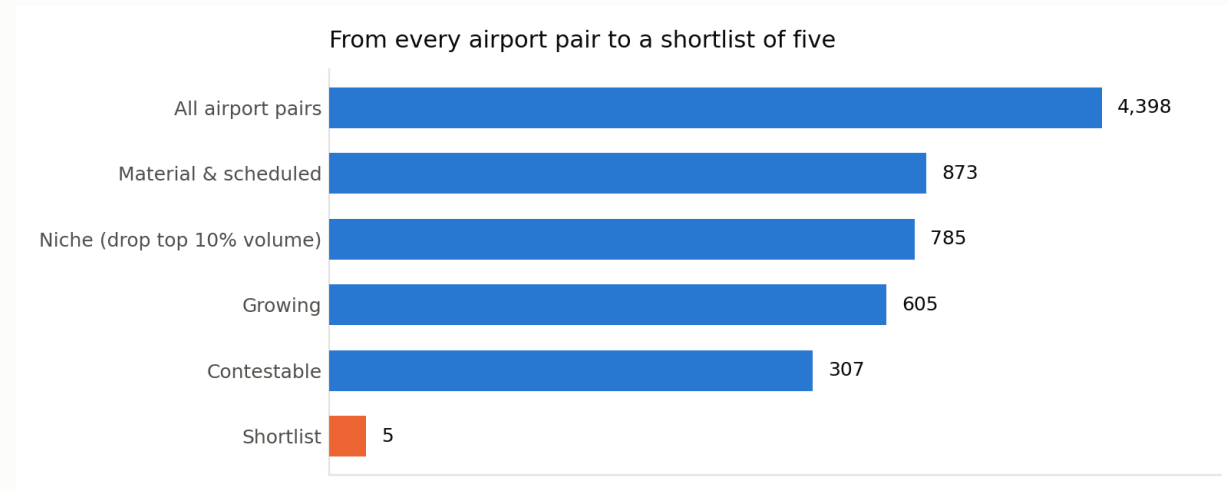
No connecting passengers
No slots at busy airports
No alliance, no brand abroad

THREATS

Incumbent adds frequency
The gap may already be filled
Leisure routes yield thin

THE FUNNEL

4,398 routes to 5 finalists.

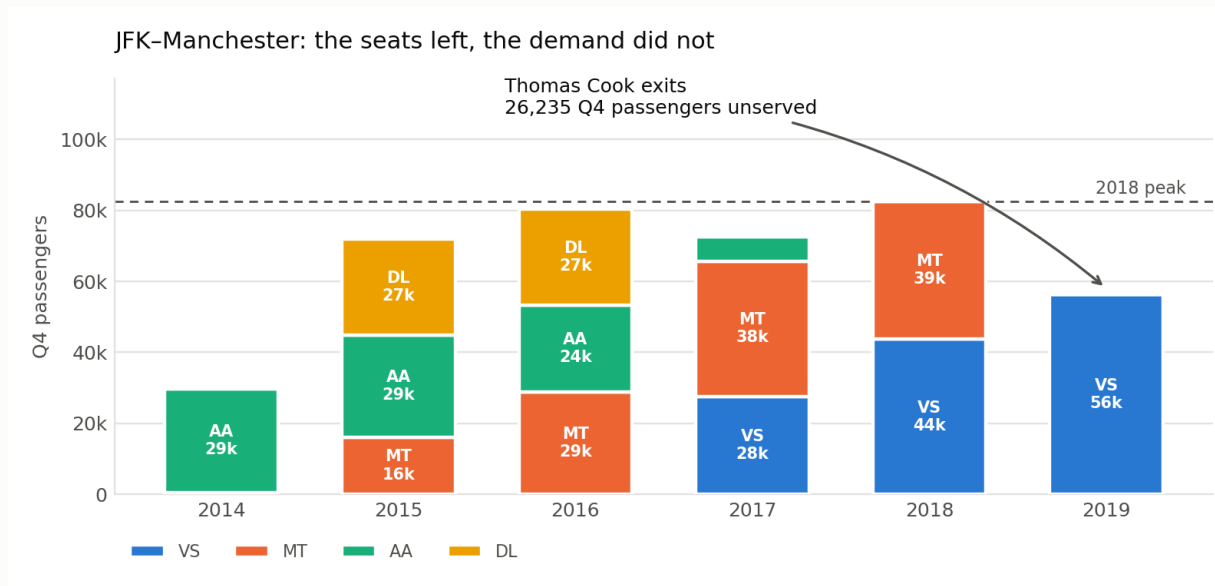


Four cuts. Real and repeating. Not the biggest. Growing. Not already owned.

The index ranks LAX-HND first. We reject it. Haneda slots are allocated between governments. Our measure sees competition, not legal walls.

THE RECOMMENDATION

JFK ⇄ Manchester.



Thomas Cook collapsed in September 2019. It carried 47% of this route. The seats went. The demand did not.

26,235

passengers left
unserved

0.83

flights a day to carry
them

That is one rotation. Exactly what the board funded.

WHERE THIS BREAKS

The weighting is the argument.

WEIGHTED TOWARD	JFK-MAN
Capturability	#1
Full planes	#1
Room to enter	#1
Equal	#2
Market size	#24

What would change our mind. Evidence that Manchester capacity was restored after 2019. The data stops three months after the gap opened.

What we cannot see. No summer in the data. No revenue, only passengers. Slots and traffic rights are invisible to the index.